MASKINHALLEN · USER MANUAL · VERSION 1.0

FRÄS

GEOMETRIC FILTER MACHINE · SHAPES · CUTS · FUNK

The bar is a circle. Up to four shapes spin inside it, and every corner cuts into the sound.



VST3 · AU · LV2 · STANDALONE
MACOS · WINDOWS · LINUX

MASKINHALLEN

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01 WELCOME

The bar is a circle. Up to four shapes spin inside it, and every corner that passes cuts into the sound with the shape's effect.

A pentagon gives five cuts per bar, a heptagon seven. Stack them and you get polyrhythm and bouncy, skewed grooves without programming a single step. Put FRÄS (Swedish for "mill", as in a milling machine) on any loop and the cuts turn into linear funk. One big MAKRO knob takes it from calm to full mill chaos. The files are called FRAS (without Ä) so they work on every computer; in the plugin it says FRÄS.

SWEDISH LABELS

`Form / Hörn / Vrid`	Shape / Corners / Rotate	`Snurr`	Spin
`Effekt / Villkor`	Effect / Condition	`Djup / Ton / Längd`	Depth / Tone / Length
`Kaos / Fyll / Sväng`	Chaos / Fill / Swing	`Linjär`	Linear
`Scener / Spara`	Scenes / Save	`Stök / Svans / Mjuk`	Mess / Tail / Soft
`Omkast / Bygg`	Shuffle / Build	`Bas-skydd`	Bass guard

THE WINDOW



02 INSTALL

Unzip the file for your system. You get a folder called **FRAS**. Then run the installer for your system and restart your DAW (or rescan plug-ins). FRÄS shows up as an audio effect.

MACOS

1. Double-click `FRAS-macOS.zip` in Downloads.
2. Open Terminal and run:
   `bash ~/Downloads/FRAS/installera.command`
3. Quit your DAW completely and start it again.

VST3, AU and a standalone app. macOS 11 or newer, Intel or Apple Silicon. The installer copies the plug-ins and removes macOS's block on downloaded plug-ins.

WINDOWS

1. Right-click `FRAS-Windows.zip` and choose **Extract all**.
2. Open the `FRAS` folder and right-click `installera.bat` → **Run as administrator**.
3. If Windows says "Windows protected your PC": **More info** → **Run anyway**.

VST3 (in C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3) and a standalone .exe. 64-bit Windows 10 or 11.

LINUX

1. Unzip `FRAS-Linux.zip`.
2. Run `bash ~/Downloads/FRAS/installera-linux.sh`. It copies the plug-ins to `~/.vst3` and `~/.lv2`.
3. Rescan plug-ins in your DAW (Bitwig, Reaper, Ardour and others).

VST3 and LV2, 64-bit x86 Linux (built on Ubuntu 22.04).

> SWEDISH OR ENGLISH
> The machines have Swedish names on the panel. One click on `SV | EN` in the header switches labels, menus and tooltips to English. Your choice is remembered for every MASKINHALLEN machine.

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03 UNLOCK WITH YOUR KEY

Your purchase comes with a licence key: four groups of four characters, like `XXXX-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX`. You find it in the Payhip email and on your receipt.

1. Open FRÄS. Until it is unlocked, the window shows **UNLOCK FRÄS**.
2. Paste the whole key in the field and press `UNLOCK`.
3. Done. You only need to do this once per computer: every MASKINHALLEN machine on the computer finds the key. A bundle key unlocks every machine.

The key is not case sensitive, and I/L and O/0 are treated as the same character, so a typo there does not matter. If it says the key does not work, check that the whole key was pasted. You can use your key on your own computers.

THE FREE DEMO

Every machine has a free demo with the same sound engine. Some presets and functions are locked, and the demo has its own name (FRÄS DEMO), so it can sit next to the full version. Buying the full version is what unlocks everything; install it and paste your key.

UPDATES

Updates are free for life. Download the new zip from your Payhip receipt link and run the installer again. Your projects and your key are kept.

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04 YOUR FIRST MINUTE

1. Put FRÄS on a drum loop, a bus or a whole track and press play.

2. Step through presets, or press `ALLT` (ALL) for a completely new setup.
3. Turn `MAKRO`: at the bottom it is calm, upward more depth and resonance, above 60 % the chaos comes in.
4. Switch on `LINJÄR` for one cut at a time, like linear drumming.
5. Use `Mix` and `Ut` (out) at the top right.

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05 THE WHEEL AND THE SHAPES

THE WHEEL

- One turn of the wheel = one bar (or 1/2, 2 or 4 bars, set with `Takt`).
- The white light is the playhead. When it passes a corner, the shape cuts.
- Hollow corners are cuts that CHAOS skips this turn.
- The strip under the wheel shows the same thing as a drum grid, 32 cells per turn.

A SHAPE (FORM 1–4)

`Effekt`	POP (resonant low-pass that pops), SKÄR (high-pass cut), STUTT (chops and repeats), KRASCH (bit crush), KAM (metallic comb), TYST (a hole in the sound), TEJPSTOPP (tape stop), BAKLÄNGES (the last bit reversed), FRYS (a tiny grain frozen into a tone), plus the newer FLÄNS, RING, DUB-KAST, SKIFT, FORMANT, PISK, OMVÄND SVANS, SVEP, STIG and FAS (see later chapters).
`Villkor`	When the shape may cut: ALWAYS, 1:2 and 2:2 (every other turn), 1:4 to 4:4 (one turn in four), FILL, NOT FILL and NEIGHBOUR (only when the shape above has just cut, so the shapes answer each other).
`Hörn`	Cuts per turn, 1 to 16.
`Vrid`	Moves all cuts. Two identical shapes with different rotation become call and response.
`Snurr`	The shape rotates by itself, so the groove changes slowly over time.
`Djup · Ton · Längd`	How hard, which colour (cutoff, bit depth, pitch, crush) and how long the cut lasts.

The shapes run in series: shape 1 → 2 → 3 → 4. The dice randomises the shape.

EFFECT PER CORNER

Under each shape, choose `HÖRN` (every other, last or random) and an **effect 2**. Then the same shape cuts with two different effects, for example POP on corner 1 and DUB-KAST on the last.

06 ORGANISED CHAOS

`DÉJÀ VU · LOOP`	Locks the chaos in a loop of 1–16 turns. At 100 % exactly the same mess comes back every loop, so it becomes a groove. At 0 % it is new every turn. In between a corner is swapped here and there, so the loop mutates slowly.
`FYLL`	Fill: more chaos, and shapes with the FILL condition wake up. Map it to a MIDI control for live fills.
`FRASFYLL`	Phrase fill: switches FILL on automatically in the last bar of every 2nd, 4th, 8th or 16th bar.
`LINJÄR`	One cut at a time: a new cut silences the others, like linear drumming. Bouncy and funky.
`SVÄNG`	Every other cut drags, like ghost notes.
`KAOS`	Corners jump a little and cuts drop out. New every turn, but the same every time you play from the same place.
`MAKRO · ALLT`	One big knob for everything, and a button that randomises a whole new setup.

07 THE KICK RULES

- FRÄS listens for the kick and learns where in the bar it hits. It shows on the **KICK** row of the strip.
- `KICK-SPÄRR` (kick lock): no cuts where the kick hits. The kick goes through completely dry and the mess lands around it.
- `PUMP`: the effect ducks against the kick and releases over a 16th.
- `BAS-SKYDD` (bass guard): everything below 80, 120 or 180 Hz bypasses the effects, in mono. Kick and sub stay tight however hard you mill.

08 SCENES AND MIDI

SCENES

The row above the wheel has 8 scenes. Press `SPARA` and then a number to save the current setup there. Click a number to recall it. Mix, Out and FILL are not touched, so the level never jumps. Scenes are saved in your project.

PLAYING FRÄS WITH MIDI

Send notes to FRÄS, for example with a MIDI clip on the same track or a note receiver. Middle C (60) is called C3, as in Bitwig and Ableton.

NOTE	WHAT HAPPENS
C1	**BROMS**: the whole output brakes like a stopping tape
C#1	**RUSA**: shapes spin twice as fast, for build-ups
D1	**FRYS**: the output freezes into a tone
D#1	**FYLL** while the key is held
E1	**BAKÅT**: the last beat plays reversed
F1	**HALVA**: shapes spin half as fast
C2–D#2	Cut with shape 1–4 directly; velocity sets how hard
C3–G3	Recall scene 1–8
C4 and up	A held note changes the key live (for KAM and RING)

Gestures last while the key is held. Let go and FRÄS is back in time.

09 NEW IN 0.5: MORE EFFECTS AND CHARACTER

Seven effects: FLÄNS (jet sweep), RING (ring modulator), DUB-KAST (only the cut is thrown into a ping-pong echo), SKIFT (the cut jumps in pitch), FORMANT (the sound talks a-e-o), PISK (the sound is whipped from side to side) and OMVÄND SVANS (what just played is reversed through a room and swells up).

`FILTER: REN / FET / ARG`: the character of POP and SKÄR. FET (fat) is warm and round, ARG (angry) has screaming resonance. `TONART` (key): KAM and RING are tuned to the track's key (natural minor).

10 NEW IN 1.0: THE STÖK PANEL

FRÄS should mess around in a fun way, not just sound glitchy. Everything new starts in a neutral position, so old projects sound exactly as before.

`STÖK`	Below the middle: fewer and longer cuts that have time to sound. Above: more chaos and shorter cuts.
`SVANS`	Tail: the effects ring out in a dark echo after the cut instead of stopping dead.
`HUGG x2 / x4 / x8`	Long cuts that ring out fully.

`MJUK`	Softer edges: cuts fade in and out.
`OMKAST`	Swaps 16ths for others from the bar, in time: BYT (swap), EKO, HOPP (jump) or SLUMP (random).
`BYGG`	Phrase building: calm at the start of the phrase, more mess towards the end.

Three new effects that move during the cut: **SVEP** (filter sweep), **STIG** (the pitch glides to an interval) and **FAS** (phaser). And 12 new presets in **GROOVE**.

11 TROUBLESHOOTING

FRÄS does not show up	Quit the DAW completely and start it again, or rescan plug-ins. On Mac, run the installer again: it removes macOS's quarantine on the plug-in. On Windows, check that `FRAS.vst3` is in C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3.
macOS says the plug-in is damaged	That is macOS's block on downloaded files. Run `bash ~/Downloads/FRAS/installera.command` again.
Windows protected your PC	Click **More info** → **Run anyway**. The plug-ins are not signed with a paid certificate.
The key does not work	Paste the whole key, including the dashes. A key for one machine only unlocks that machine; a bundle key unlocks all.
No sound	Press play in the DAW: the machines follow the transport. Instruments go on an instrument track, effects on an audio track or bus.

Anything else? Ask through the store, and the person who built the machine answers.

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